Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California

July, 2002

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To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank email to: lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com

Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, July 10th, 7:00 pm, *Lakewood School*

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa 10 Hulyo, 2002, 7:00 pm sa Lakewood School

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el 10 Julio, 2002 a las 7:00 pm en el Lakewood School

From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

What's new this month…

Perhaps it is serendipity, or maybe it is simply coincidence, but last month's issue of the LVNA Villager seemed to have a distinct theme about parks, the environment, and nature, and this month's theme seems to be about neighborhood preservation issues. I wish I could say that it was a planned editorial event, but it was just what happened – our readers and contributors control the content of this newsletter.

Along with the neighborhood preservation issues, there is some additional information about Internet matters for Lakewood Village – direct access for you, and a web site for the LVNA. Read all about it!

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During the past month our LVNA President, Craig Crawford, has been outside of the USA

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and has not been able to make his usual contributions to the Villager. You will notice the absence of the President's Column and the Police Blotter, as well as other articles that Craig normally submits for inclusion in the Villager. Look forward to their return in August. In the meantime, you'll have to put up with my writing.

Your input is always valued

As always, I'm looking for new sources of articles for the Villager. If you have any urge to write an article, please do! Or, if you have any suggestions for articles to be written by others, send them to me as well.

To contact the Editor of the Villager…

Send your articles, comments, and corrections by email to lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com (note that this is a new email address), by FAX to (408) 738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■

Progress on an LVNA Web Site

- Editor

Watch this space for information about an LVNA web site at www.lvna.net. The Internet domain name has been registered, and hosting services are being provided by a local Internet Service Provider (owned by a former Lakewood Village resident). More information will be provided in next month's issue. ■

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- Editor

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Pilot Program Survey Results

- Richard Gutierrez, Neighborhood Preservation

As many of you know, the City's Community Development Department met with the officers of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association to discuss a pilot program designed to enhance the quality of life in our neighborhood. The objective of the program is to improve the overall maintenance, appearance and safety of properties in Lakewood Village. The program will attempt to establish a partnership between residents and City staff to identify property maintenance priorities, and then address the highest priorities through education, assistance and (as a last resort) code enforcement.

The Pilot Program, a cooperative between the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association and the City is taking shape. On June 20, 2002 the LVNA Board met with the City to discuss the specific locations where the Pilot Program would be most beneficial to the Lakewood Village residents. The Board and the City mutually agreed to conduct the Pilot Program in the areas of **Lakehaven Drive between Lawrence and Meadowlake Drive and all of Lakenoll Drive.** This area is great for Lakewood Village because it is highly visible and is one of the main gateways into our community. This is also an area where a relatively large number of respondents to the survey indicated a desire to participate in the Pilot Program.

The LVNA Board distributed 1,700 surveys (one to each home) in the June newsletter, 249 surveys were completed and returned to the City to calculate the results. Residents of Lakewood Village ranked specific code enforcement issues as "not important", "important", or "very important". **The results indicate to the City what we, as a community, consider important as well as not important.**

The code enforcement issues below are ranked from highest to lowest, in the "very important" column. For example, Garbage, debris, furniture, etc. stored in public view, was ranked #1 in the very important category. (71% of the respondents indicated that this issue was very important. And, only 5% indicated that this issue was not important.) Weeds ranked #6 in the category of very important and fences exceeding the City's height limitations was ranked #17; only 19% of the respondents indicated that this issue was very important.

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		Not Important	Important	Very Important
1.	Garbage, debris, furniture, equipment, etc. stored within the front and/or side yard (in public view).	5%	22%	71%
2.	Vegetation obstructing the sidewalk and/or street.	9%	40%	50%
3.	Vehicles parked on an unpaved surface.	18%	31%	48%
4.	Inoperable vehicles parked/stored on the driveway.	24%	27%	46%
5.	Vehicles parked/stored on the street for more than 72 hours.	21%	32%	45%
6.	Weeds in the front and/or side yard.	14%	39%	44%
7.	Vegetation over 2 feet in height within the parking strip (the area between the sidewalk and street).	25%	29%	44%
8.	Commercial vehicles parked in the neighborhood.	22%	29%	43%
9.	Trash and recycling containers not properly screened from public view, stored in the front or side yard.	18%	41%	39%
10.	Accessory buildings, roof extensions, etc. constructed too close to neighbors' property.	23%	37%	39%
11.	Overgrown shrubs and hedges.	18%	43%	37%
12.	Houses that lack adequate weather protection (bare and exposed wood, peeling paint.).	20%	41%	37%
13.	Businesses operating out of the home, garage, or yard without proper permits.	28%	34%	37%
14.	Garage conversions without proper permits.	35%	28%	35%
15.	Make shift additions (room additions, patio covers, porches, carports, sheds, enclosed patios, etc.) built without proper permits.	30%	35%	35%
16.	Front yards paved in excess of 50 percent.	39%	29%	31%
17.	Fences exceeding the City's height limitations (3 feet in front yard, 6 feet in side/rear yard).	51%	28%	19%

The City will be attending the July 10, 2002 LVNA meeting at Lakewood School in the multi-purpose room, located at 750 Lakechime Drive at 7:00 p.m., to provide more information and answer questions about the Pilot Program, including the boundaries and survey results. In August, the City will hold a meeting with all of the residents and property owners within the Pilot Program's boundaries. (Residents and property owners will be notified by mail of the time and location.)

For those of you who reside within the boundaries of the Pilot Program, please contact Richard Gutierrez, Neighborhood Preservation Specialist with the City of Sunnyvale, at (408) 730-7447 or at rgutierrez@ci.sunnyvale.ca.us if you'd like to provide input or have questions. If you reside outside of this area, your input is also welcome.

The LVNA Board and the City would like you to know that your input is valuable and we sincerely thank you for your time.

Sincerely,

LVNA Board of Directors ■

President's Column

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

There is no President's Column this month, because Craig has been out of the country. Stay tuned for next month... ■

Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

Your LVNA is in need of a few good folks to help get the message out. It takes only a few minutes a month, gets you out of the house into the fresh air, and gives you an opportunity to meet some of your neighbors. If you can devote some time as a Newsletter Walker, please call Elena at 745-6028. It's a great way to make a contribution to the Neighborhood! ■



The Right to Be...

James L. Daugerty

I was just reading over the last two copies of the Villager, our own neighborhood newsletter. It is a means to talk to our neighbors and express our ideas and personal concerns about where we live, and as a forum for leadership and change. It is democracy at one of our most basic levels.

And so I write to my fellow Villagers about a problem for us that seems to be evolving and gaining strength. I am asking you for guidance and your opinions, so please respond.

My problem seems to be with the pro-active nature of our City government and certain people in our LVNA. I do very much believe in

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looking after our neighborhood and making sure the properties we live in are kept in reasonably good shape. It enhances the value of the property if it's ours or not, and enhances the comfort level of the neighborhood that permits us to take pride in our community, and satisfy the needs of public safety. Beyond that, we come to a point where what we do and how we live is our business and no one else's. It is our inherent right to be left alone.

It seems that this pro-active philosophy, if allowed to gain strength, may divide us as neighbors. We may no longer ask our neighbors to move their cars, clean up their oil spils, turn down their overly loud stereos, control their pets, take down their Christmas lights, or whatever the problem may be. It's easier to stay anonymous and secretive, and just turn 'em into the City.

There is an element of fear here, too. If I turn in my neighbor, then sooner or later he's going to find something on me to turn me in for. Rare is the neighbor that is perfect and never does anything wrong. And so we become apprehensive, angry, and intolerant of each other.

So let's be neighbors to our neighbors and help out when we can. We can be pro-active among ourselves. By taking care of our neighborhood, and showing civil respect to others before there is a problem, so this problem that I speak of will disappear on it's own. ■

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From the Police Blotter: Lakewood Village and nearby areas

- Courtesy of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety and Craig Crawford



Editor's note: Sorry – no Police Blotter this month. This feature will return next month, and we'll cover both June and July.

As always, if you see suspicious activity or are aware of any crime, no matter how minor it may seem, please report it to Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety. For emergencies, call 911; for non-emergencies, call 730-7100. ■

This Month in Lakewood History…

- Brian Smithson

44 years ago: In 1958, the first LVRA Picnic was held at Blackberry Farms. At the time, there was no Lakewood Park.

44 years ago: Also in 1958, a fence was established at Havenwood to block access to Calabazas Creek, which was a hazard for children.

39 years ago: In 1963, it was predicted that homes in Lakewood Village would sell for as much as $20,000 by 1968!

37 years ago: In 1965, the first LVRA "Western Days" event was held in Dick's Plaza.

9 years ago: In 1993, Giovanni's opened in Dick's Plaza.

Share <u>your</u> history!

Are you a long-time resident of Lakewood Village? Do you have old photographs, real estate brochures, newspaper clippings, or old LVRA/LVNA newsletters sitting in a box in your garage? I'm interested in putting together a year-by-year history of Lakewood Village, and your historical materials would be very helpful. I'd be happy to pick up items, copy them, and return the originals. Call me at 738-5939 or email lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com. ■





Letters to the LVNA

- Editor

We actually got a few letters! Here they are. Names have been withheld for privacy.

June 9, 2002

I live on Blazingwood Drive. My backyard is next to Lawrence Expressway. A number of years ago the County put up a concrete block fence between Sandia and Tasman. The concrete blocks are connected with wooden connectors. I noticed a few days ago that the wooden connectors are deteriorating. I decided to drive along Lawrence Expressway to see if my yard was the only affected. It is happening all along this block. My question is - "Do you happen to have the address of the County office that was in charge of building this fence? I feel that they need to look to see if the fence has lost any of its strength. If you are driving north on Lawrence Expressway from Sandia would you mind looking at the fence and letting me know if you feel there is not problem or if something needs to be done. Thank you.

Editor's note: I've forwarded your message to the Santa Clara County Department of Roads and Airports, at roads@countyroads.org. I've copied you on the email so that you they can respond to you directly. □

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June 10, 2002

Hello Craig,

My family and I have lived in Fairwood for about 15 years. We bought our home on Prescott 8 years ago. For the past 2 years the parking on our street has been obsolete. The family across the street has on any given day 8-10 cars parked in the driveway, in front of our house, the neighbors, down the street etc. Sunday night we couldn't even put our garbage cans out per City of Sunnyvale instruction because of the parking. Our driveway has even been blocked. There is also a person living in his/her car that is constantly parked in front. I have also heard from other neighbors that are home during the day that some sort of business operation is going on. Employees and parts of some sort were being delivered this morning.

So, maybe you can mention something in the next newsletter. I don't want to cause any problems but the situation has to be addressed at some point. My next letter is to City of Sunnyvale.

I thought Lakewood Village/Fairwood was single family living.

Thank you for taking the time to read my letter. I look forward to hearing from you soon. Have a great day.

Editor's note: Craig forwarded this to the City's Neighborhood Preservation Group. □

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June 17, 2002

Dear Mr. Smithson,

I am writing this letter concerning vehicles parked on the street. These vehicles are being issued tickets for violation of public law 10.16.120 MC. I have lived in this community for 27 years in the same house, and this is the first time I have been ticketed with regard to this violation. I've been ticketed twice in this one year! For the past 27 years, I have parked my car on the street right in front of my house and always in the same spot. I do this because my driveway is already full with five other cars that my working family uses. I drive my car every day when I go to work in the evenings, but during the day, it is in the same place. Apparently, the officer who ticketed my car thinks that I do not ever move my car. My neighbors of many years are also experiencing the same frustration of these tickets as they do the same sort of parking I do: right in front of their house in the same spot every day.

My neighbors and I request further details of section 10.16.120 MC. We are frustrated that we can no longer utilize the street parking available right in front of our own homes without being ticketed. Please respond and publish this letter in the next issue of the LVNA Villager. Thank you for your help.

Editors note: The entire Sunnyvale Municipal Code is available on the Internet at the following address:

http://ordlink.com/codes/sunnyval/index.htm

This particular section of the code says that you cannot leave a car in the same spot for 72 or more consecutive hours without having been moved at least one mile. By your description, you have not violated this code. ■

High Speed Internet Access in Lakewood Village

- Brian Smithson

In last month's issue, I asked our neighbors to share their experience of trying to get DSL or other high speed Internet access in Lakewood Village. I have summarized and paraphrased the responses that I received:

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- Installed PacBell DSL in April 2002, and has worked fine from day one.
- I have AT&T Broadband cable modem and get reliable connections of 366Kbps and above. I used to have AOL DSL, but experienced frequent connection losses.
- Have AT&T Broadband cable and also use a wireless gateway to access it in the back yard. I know of two other people in the neighborhood, one with AOL DSL and another with AT&T cable. *[Lakefair]*
- Have had AT&T Broadband (originally @Home) cable for about a year, with no problems. *[Manzano]*
- Tried to get DSL from the phone company, but they said they'd need to install some kind of repeater for me to get full speed and they would charge extra for that. Later, I signed up with AT&T Cable and have had no problems.
- Have had SBC/PacBell DSL since November, 2000. 13,500 feet from the central office. *[distance is a major factor in determining the maximum speed you'll get with DSL and 14,500 feet is the limit]*
- Earthlink told me I was in range and could get ADSL. Their self-installation kit didn't work, and so Covad and then Covad and SBC/PacBell came out to investigate. Although my home is within range (13,000 feet), the way the wires run it ends up being 21,000 feet. They said I could get IDSL, which is slower and more expensive, so I have dial-up. *[Twinlake]*
- I was able to get DSL from US Sprint/Earthlink *[actually, it's called Sprint Broadband Direct]* using a small dish antenna, but it had to be put up on a 15-foot mast.

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- We have tried to get AOL, Earthlink, Pacific Bell and Direct TV DSL but they do not cover our address. Finally we called AT&T Broadband and got that. *[Fairwood area]*

- We have been trying to get DSL from Earthlink for over three years and can't. AT&T has been trying to hook up DSL subscribers on the Cable TV system. I don't want to see this happen as the Cable TV system is getting slower every day to respond to info requests (MENU). With DSL over cable, it would get so slow as to be unusable. *[Pecos]*

- I have an AT&T cable modem that works well. The initial set-up was sort of a hassle--it took some coordination to finally get a service technician out here to hook it up. But it's been reliable for over a year. When Excite@Home went bankrupt, I lost service for a few days, but then it came back on line. I tried PacBell for DSL and no luck. *[Soccoro]*

- Took about a year of pestering DSL and cable companies (who always said it would be rolled out "in a couple of weeks") until Flashcom finally provided IDSL service to my neighborhood (outside of range for regular Pac-bell DSL). Flashcom took 6 months of messing around to get the line working and then went out of business after a year. I was able to switch to AT&T cable modem at that time but they also have problems (dynamic IP, poor uptimes and problem resolution).

- We got Pacific Bell DSL over a year ago and have been quite pleased with it. There have been a few periods of slowness and were a few outages in the early days but all in all it has worked as advertised.*[Lakechime]*

- I have used DSL since June 2000. My current service provider is Earthlink. They were called Mindspring at the time I had DSL installed. My experience with installation was very easy and have received excellent service ever since. *[Hiddenlake]*

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- I was thoroughly frustrated in trying to get a DSL connection through SBC/PacBell. I first tried to get it over two years ago. I checked the Pac Bell web site which said that it was available, but then when I called and spoke to a Pac Bell sales representative they informed me that it was not available and no one has been able to say whenit would be available. They would just say check back in six months. I continued to check periodically, but with "no availability at this time". After 18 months of this, I went with the AT&T cable service, they hooked it up immediately and it has worked great ever since. *[Velvet Lake]*

- I had DSL installed about three years ago. Initially the service was poor. They had to get their server problems cleaned up and then I had them come to my house with a Time Domain Reflectometer. They discovered two stubs between my house and the central office. Since these were repaired I've had excellent service. *[Twinlake]*

- I have tried to get DSL through my current provider (Earthlink) but was told Pac Bell them that it is not available in this area. Was told the best they could do was IDSL for $100/month *[Soccoro]*

My own story is that I tried to get DSL a few years ago from Flashcom, then Concentric, and then PacBell, and none were successful. I got a microwave antenna solution from WavePath, which was later acquired by Sprint Broadband Direct, and that's the service I use today. *[Burntwood]*

From this small sample, I concluded that DSL has been somewhat available mostly in the Lakewood side of the Village and not so much in the Fairwood side, and that AT&T Cable is widely available and provides reasonable service at this time.

The best news is from a telephone call I received from one of our neighbors who is a retired PacBell employee. She was also unable to get DSL, but was informed by PacBell that they are upgrading equipment and lines and will offer DSL in August-September in our area. I will try to find out more and report in the next issue. ■

LVNA Officials

President	Craig Crawford iamcraw@earthlink.net	736-7371
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2nd Vice President	Elena Anderson anderson@elmetek.com	745-6028
Secretary	Tom Freeman	734-5769
Treasurer	Thom Meyer	
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- Editor

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Public Safety – Non-emergency		**730-7100**
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Animal Control		730-7178
Code Enforcement		730-7610
Crime Prevention		730-7140
Hazardous Materials		730-7212
Housing Inspection		730-7610
Lakewood Pool		734-8190
Street Light Repairs		730-7510
Shopping Cart Retrieval		730-7510
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Vehicle Abatement	Sally Personett	730-7104
Neighborhood Preservation	Rich Gutierrez	730-7447

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Internet Links

Lakewood Village email list	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage
City of Sunnyvale	http://www.ci.sunnyvale.ca.us/
State of California	http://www.ca.gov/
Lakewood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Lakewood/index.html
Fairwood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Fairwood/index.html
Coming soon: an LVNA Web Site!	Look for details in an upcoming edition of the Villager

Calendar of Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Bookmobile	Fairwood School	7/9/02 and 7/23/02, 2:15-3pm
LVNA General Meeting	Lakewood School	7/10/02, 7-8pm
Bookmobile	Lakewood School	7/11/02 and 7/25/02, 2-3pm
Dumpster Weekend	various Lakewood locations	7/20/02-7/21/02

LVNA Meeting

- Editor

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend this monthly meeting. You will meet some of your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions, and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, July 10th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: Lakewood School
(NOTE: it's at Lakewood School, *not* at the Lakewood Park building). ■





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